

HAB

HEALTHY AUTO BUSINESS

The Advisor Book

The Sales Operating System for Service Advisors

For: Service Advisors, Service Writers, and anyone who answers the phone, greets the customer, presents the DVI, handles the objection, or closes the sale. This is your playbook from Rookie to Champion.

VERSION 1.3 · CONFIDENTIAL & PROPRIETARY

THE HAB OATH

I will assure every customer they called the right place.

I will earn the appointment instead of quoting blindly.

I will run the bases in order.

I will defeat the bosses with words, not arguments.

I will $L \rightarrow A \rightarrow S \rightarrow T$ when things go wrong.

I will treat every car as if it carries my own family.

And I will never forget —

DO WHAT'S RIGHT · DO WHAT'S FAIR · DO YOUR BEST

ADVISOR SIGNATURE

DATE

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P R E F A C E

How to Use This Book

It's not a binder for the drawer. It's a training weapon for the bench.

This book is your operating manual from your first day as a Rookie to the day customers ask for you by name and you train other advisors. It is structured to be read, drilled, and re-read.

Your Reading Plan

1. **Week 0:** Read the Foundation chapter cover-to-cover. Sign the Oath. Commit.
2. **Weeks 1–9:** One module per week. Read it Monday. Drill it Tuesday through Friday. Take the Mastery Check live.
3. **After Week 9:** Re-read the Worked-Example Library quarterly. Re-take Mastery Checks for any module where your KPIs slip.

The Callout Color Code

SCRIPT The exact words Memorize tone, not just text.	PSYCH DECODER Why it works Stop sounding scripted.
DRILL The rep Build the instinct.	MASTERY The gate Live behaviors, not opinion.
STOP Hard gate Do not skip.	PRO TIP Veteran shortcut Earned the hard way.

The Five Levels

- 1 **Rookie** — Reads scripts. Survives calls. No improvisation.
- 2 **Advisor** — Runs scripts naturally. Concern vs. symptom. Books without quoting.
- 3 **Closer** — Owns East-West. Runs the bases. PRS by heart.
- 4 **Pro** — Defeats all 8 Bosses. Re-opens missed sales.
- 5 **Champion** — Customers request you. You train others. You build the book.

CHAPTER 0

Foundation

The principle behind every word, drill, and KPI in this book.

The Core Principle

*Sales is not persuasion. Sales is the systematic reduction of uncertainty.
We do not sell repairs. We manufacture certainty — and certainty buys repairs by itself.*

Every customer who calls or walks in is in a fog. Uncertain whether the noise is dangerous. Uncertain whether they're about to be hustled. Uncertain whether the price will be fair. **That fog is the real problem we solve.** Repairs are the byproduct.

The Customer Arc

Enters

Uncertain · Fearful · Defensive · Confused

Leaves

Educated · Confident · Safe · Loyal

The Six Sales Objectives

Every move you make — every word, pause, walk, inspection — must serve at least one. If a behavior doesn't serve one, it's waste motion. Cut it.

OBJ 1 Build Relationship Make a friend.	OBJ 2 Get Custody The car in our bay is the only car we can save.	OBJ 3 Separate Customer from Vehicle Distance enables decisions.
OBJ 4 Identify Vehicle Health The DVI is our X-ray.	OBJ 5 Educate the Customer Informed = confident = authorized.	OBJ 6 Deliver Safe & Reliable The repair is the receipt. The relationship is the asset.

The 8-Step Sales Process

#	Step	Uncertainty Removed
1	Establish Rapport	"Are these people safe?"
2	Establish Credibility	"Do they know what they're doing?"
3	Collect Data / Get Custody	"What's actually wrong?"
4	Inspect & Analyze	"How bad is it really?"
5	Build & Strategize	"Where do we start?"
6	Present	"Why does this matter?"
7	Overcome Objections	"Should I really do this?"
8	Execute / Close	"What happens next?"

The Invisible Scorecard

Every customer silently grades you on three traits, in this order. Score all three → price becomes irrelevant. Lose any one → price becomes the only conversation that ever happens.

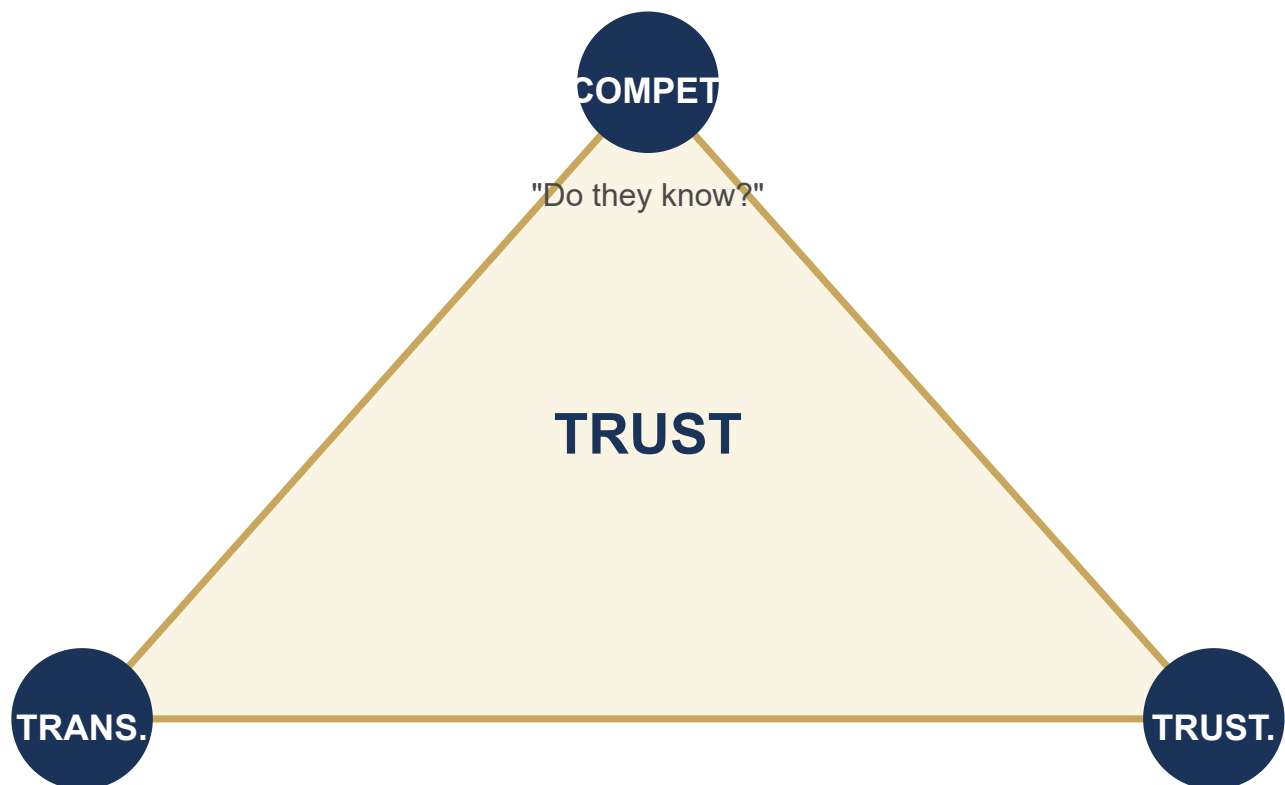


Figure 0.1 · The Trust Triangle — three legs, no shortcuts

CHAPTER 1

Establish Rapport

Make a friend in 90 seconds.

OBJECTIVE MAKE A FRIEND	TIME 90 SECONDS	PRIMARY KPI GREET→TOUR %	FAIL MODE SOUNDS SCRIPTED
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The Psychology — Why Rapport Works

When a stranger calls or walks in, their amygdala runs a sub-second threat assessment: **Is this person safe? Are they like me?** If either answer is "no," the reasoning brain goes offline and every word you say gets filtered through suspicion.

Rapport flips both answers to "yes" inside 90 seconds. Three mechanisms do the work:

- **Mirror Neurons** — humans copy the emotional state of the person in front of them. Set the thermostat.
- **Limbic Resonance** — pace and rhythm sync. Calm advisor pulls panicked customer to calm.
- **Reciprocity** — give first (greeting, water, eye contact) and the brain creates a tiny obligation.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER Why "you called the right place" beats "how can I help."

The brain is scanning for relief. "Right place" is a one-sentence relief delivery — it tells the limbic system "the threat is resolved, you can stop searching." The body literally exhales. From that exhale forward, everything you say is heard by the reasoning brain instead of suspicion.

The Three Channels

Channel	"On"	"Off"
Tone	Smile audible, pace softens on "right place"	Monotone, sounds like third call
Words	"Right place", "Oh wow", "I'll personally..."	"Sure", "yeah", third-person dodges
Body	Stand up, eye contact within 2 sec, smile precedes words	Stay seated, look at screen, crossed arms

Scripts — The Exact Words

SCRIPT The Greeting (before ring 3)

You: [SMILE] "Thank you for calling [Shop]. My name is [Your Name]." [PAUSE]

If they hesitate: "How can I help you today?"

SCRIPT The Relief Line

Customer: "Do you work on brakes?"

You: "You called the *right place*! Is this your first time with our shop?"

SCRIPT The Concern Pivot (any concern)

You: "Oh wow! *WHEN* you're experiencing [concern], it's always best to bring your vehicle in and have it inspected by one of our certified technicians. Is now a good time?"

SCRIPT The East-West Close

You: "I have an opening at 9:15 or 10:45. Which works best for you?"

Rule: One time must be :15 after, the other must be :45 to. Always two options. Never "what time works?"

PRO TIP Use the customer's name 3 times in the first 2 minutes.

Greeting, concern pivot, hand-off. After three uses, the relationship feels personal to the subconscious. Don't overdo it — four+ in two minutes flips to creepy.

The 5 Common Mistakes

#	Mistake	Quick Fix
1	Letting phone ring 4+ times	2-ring rule. No exceptions.
2	Greeting from behind a monitor	Stand-and-smile on every door open.
3	Answering price in first 30 sec	Reflex: "at no cost to you, I'll personally..."
4	Filler words (um, uh, like)	Silence beats filler. Hold the pause.
5	Skipping the customer's name	Name on boom board. Eyes on it every callback.

The Drills**DRILL 1.A Smile-Through-Voice**

Setup: Partner holds a mirror. You place a real call. Deliver the greeting twice — once mouth flat, once smiling visibly.

Score: can the listener hear the smile? **Goal:** 8+/10 on three consecutive reps.

DRILL 1.B The Pause

Setup: Trainer plays customer. You deliver the greeting and hold full silence for 2 seconds even if the customer hesitates.

Goal: 5 consecutive reps no filler. Unlocks Level 2.

DRILL 1.C Name × 3

Setup: Full simulated call. Work the customer's first name into the conversation exactly 3 times within 2 minutes — greeting, concern pivot, hand-off. **Goal:** 3/3 on five live calls in a single shift.

DRILL 1.D The Cold-Open Roleplay

Setup: Use the AI roleplay bot in "hostile cold caller" mode (opens with "just tell me how much an oil change costs").

Goal: convert to East-West appointment in 90 sec without quoting.

LEVEL 1 — RAPPORT MASTERY

- ☐ Picked up before third ring with audible smile.
- ☐ Used relief line ("right place") within first 10 seconds.
- ☐ Paused after opening line, let customer speak first.
- ☐ Said customer's first name 3 times in first 2 minutes.
- ☐ Did NOT quote a price during the rapport window.
- ☐ Closed with East-West appointment or warm hand-off.

Pass all 6 across 3 consecutive live calls → promoted to Advisor (Level 2). Signed: _____ Date: _____

RAPPORT SELF-AUDIT (FILL OUT AFTER EACH SHIFT)

Calls today: _____

Smile audible (Y/N count): _____

Pause held (Y/N count): _____

Relief line delivered (Y/N count): _____

Name 3× used (Y/N count): _____

Greet-to-tour %: _____

One improvement tomorrow: _____

CHAPTER 2

Establish Credibility

Build authority before money enters the conversation.

OBJECTIVE AUTHORITY	TIME 90-SEC TOUR	PRIMARY KPI TOUR→DVI %	FAIL MODE BRAGGING
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The Principle — Show, Don't Tell

Credibility is not what you say about yourself. Credibility is what the customer concludes after seeing the evidence. A confident claim ("we're the best") triggers skepticism. A demonstrated detail ("certified tech, loaner fleet, warranty") triggers conclusion.

The Tour as Authority Play

Each line in the tour script scores one or more legs of the Trust Triangle. If a line scores nothing, cut it.

Tour Line	What It's Doing	Trust Leg
"your certified dealer alternative"	Authority-by-association — dealer category, independent prices	Competence
"ASE and dealer-certified technicians"	External validation	Competence
"3-year / 36,000-mile nationwide warranty"	Risk reversal	Trustworthy
"shuttle, Uber, loaner, rental reimbursement"	Removes "I can't leave my car" objection	Trustworthy
"digital inspections, electronic approvals"	Transparency made visible	Transparency
"Can I get you coffee or water?"	Reciprocity trigger	Trustworthy

The Three Hidden Sales Inside the Tour

1 Inspection Authorization By the end the customer has already mentally agreed to a DVI.	2 Price Defense They no longer compare you to Cheap Bob's — different product.	3 Repeat Visit Toured customers refer. Drop-off customers don't.
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SCRIPT The Shop Tour (walking pace, eye contact, warmth)

"Welcome to [Shop], your certified dealer alternative. We're proud to have certified technicians ready to take care of all your vehicle needs — tires, maintenance, major repairs. We also partner with trusted local specialists for accessory work like dent repair, body work, and windshield replacement so you're covered in one place.

To make your visit convenient, we offer complimentary shuttle rides, Uber or Lyft, rental car reimbursement, and loaner vehicles when available. If you stay, the waiting area has complimentary water, coffee, and tea — but there's no need to wait if transportation works better.

Once you drop off, we keep you informed every step of the way: calls, texts, digital vehicle inspections, and electronic approvals for estimates, invoices, and payment. Clear, simple, transparent.

We're excited to serve you today, and thank you for trusting [Shop]. Can I get you something to drink — coffee, water, or tea?"

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER Why ending with the drink offer matters.

The drink offer is the final reciprocity trigger and creates a tiny social contract: the customer is now "a guest" in our space, not "a transaction." Guests don't haggle. Guests don't walk out. Guests authorize inspections.

LEVEL 2 — CREDIBILITY MASTERY

- ☐ Delivered full shop tour in under 90 seconds, walking pace, eye contact.
- ☐ Mentioned certified techs, warranty, transportation options.
- ☐ Offered drink at the end.
- ☐ Did NOT brag — demonstrated rather than claimed.
- ☐ Customer's body language visibly relaxed by the end.

Pass all 5 across 3 live tours → Credibility certified. Signed: _____ Date: _____

CHAPTER 3

Collect Data — Get Custody

Get the car in the bay. Separate customer from vehicle. Document the true concern.

OBJECTIVE GET CUSTODY	TOOL BOOM BOARD	PRIMARY KPI INQUIRY→RO %	FAIL MODE SELF-DIAGNOSIS
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The Psychology of Custody

The single most under-valued asset in the shop is **the car in our bay**. You cannot inspect a car you don't have. You cannot sell repairs on a car you don't have. Custody is the gateway to every other objective.

The corollary: the second the vehicle is in the bay, you have also *separated the customer from the vehicle*. They're in the waiting room. Their emotional attachment to the symptom decays. Logical decisions become possible. **Separation is what enables education.**

Concern vs. Symptom — The Most Important Distinction

Customers describe **symptoms**. Professionals diagnose **concerns**. The single biggest source of wasted shop time is taking a customer's self-diagnosis at face value. "I need new brakes" is a symptom statement — the concern might be a wheel bearing, a stuck caliper, or a low- friction tire. Convert symptom to concern gently, without making the customer feel stupid.

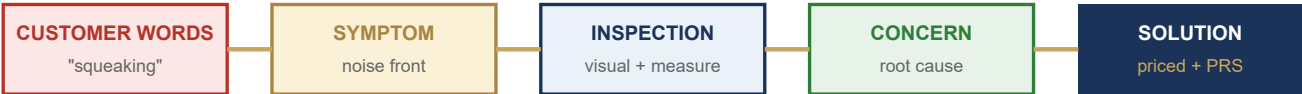


Figure 3.1 · The Diagnosis Funnel

The Custody Question Sequence

- 1 **Acknowledge concern** — "Oh wow, when you're experiencing [concern]..."
- 2 **Imply expertise required** — "...it's always best to have a certified tech inspect."
- 3 **Assume the appointment** — "Is now a good time?"
- 4 **East-West close** — "9:15 or 10:45?"
- 5 **Custody hand-off** — "Stay with me while I get you in our system."

STOP No boom board, no bay.

If a tech is performing work on a vehicle without a documented concern in the system, Step 3 has been skipped. Stop the work. Document. Then proceed. This single discipline protects the shop from miscommunication and the customer from surprise.

LEVEL 3 — CUSTODY MASTERY

- ☐ Converted customer's symptom language to a documented concern.
- ☐ Did NOT accept self-diagnosis at face value.
- ☐ Used East-West to book on the first offer.
- ☐ Boom board / RO fully populated before vehicle enters the bay.
- ☐ Customer separated from vehicle within 10 minutes of arrival.

CHAPTER 4

Inspect & Analyze the Data

A complete, honest, documented picture of the vehicle's true health.

OBJECTIVE VEHICLE HEALTH	TOOL DVI + MEDIA	PRIMARY KPI DVI W/ MEDIA %	FAIL MODE PARTIAL DVI
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The DVI is the Customer's X-Ray

The inspection is not for the tech — the tech already knows what's wrong. The DVI — with photos, video, and notes — is for the **customer**. It's the evidence we hand them in Chapter 6 so they can *see* what we see.

The DVI is not a checklist. It is the X-ray we hand the customer so they stop being afraid of the diagnosis.

Vehicle Health Dashboard — Green / Yellow / Red

A great DVI sorts every finding into one of three buckets. This sort is the foundation of base selling.

GREEN

Healthy — no action needed. Within spec. Used to prime "Good-Good-Bad."

YELLOW

Maintenance — due soon, not urgent. Sold on 3rd base, soft tone.

RED

Safety — address now. Failure imminent or will damage other systems. Sold on 1st base, full PRS.

Tech-Advisor Walk-the-Bay (the handoff)

- 1 Advisor physically meets the tech at the vehicle within 15 minutes of DVI completion.
- 2 Tech explains the finding. Advisor takes notes. No interruptions.
- 3 Advisor reflects tech's language in customer-friendly terms. Tech corrects if needed.
- 4 Together: confirm PRS — Problem, Risk, Solution, Investment, Warranty.
- 5 Both initial the RO so accountability is shared.

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER Why a thorough DVI shortens objections.

"The price seems high" is almost always shorthand for "I'm not sure this is real." A DVI with photos, video, and tech notes destroys the "not real" doubt before the objection forms. Shops with DVI-completion rates above 95% report dramatically lower price-objection rates — not because their prices are lower, but because their evidence is higher.

LEVEL 4 — INSPECTION MASTERY

- ☐ DVI completed bumper-to-bumper, every section.
- ☐ Every Yellow and Red finding has at least one photo or video.
- ☐ Tech walk-the-bay completed within 15 minutes of DVI completion.
- ☐ Customer sent DVI via text/email and viewed (confirmed) before presentation call.
- ☐ PRS drafted for every Red and Yellow finding before any callback.

CHAPTER 5

Build & Strategize — Run the Bases

Isolate, expand, protect, reinforce — never kitchen-sink.

OBJECTIVE SEQUENCE THE CALL	FRAMEWORK BASEBALL DIAMOND	PRIMARY KPI BASE ORDER %	FAIL MODE KITCHEN-SINKING
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The Baseball Diamond

The #1 reason customers say "let me think about it" is not price — it's **overwhelm**. When you present safety, maintenance, upsells, and recovery in one breath, the brain freezes. The Diamond prevents this: one base at a time, in order, authorize each before advancing.

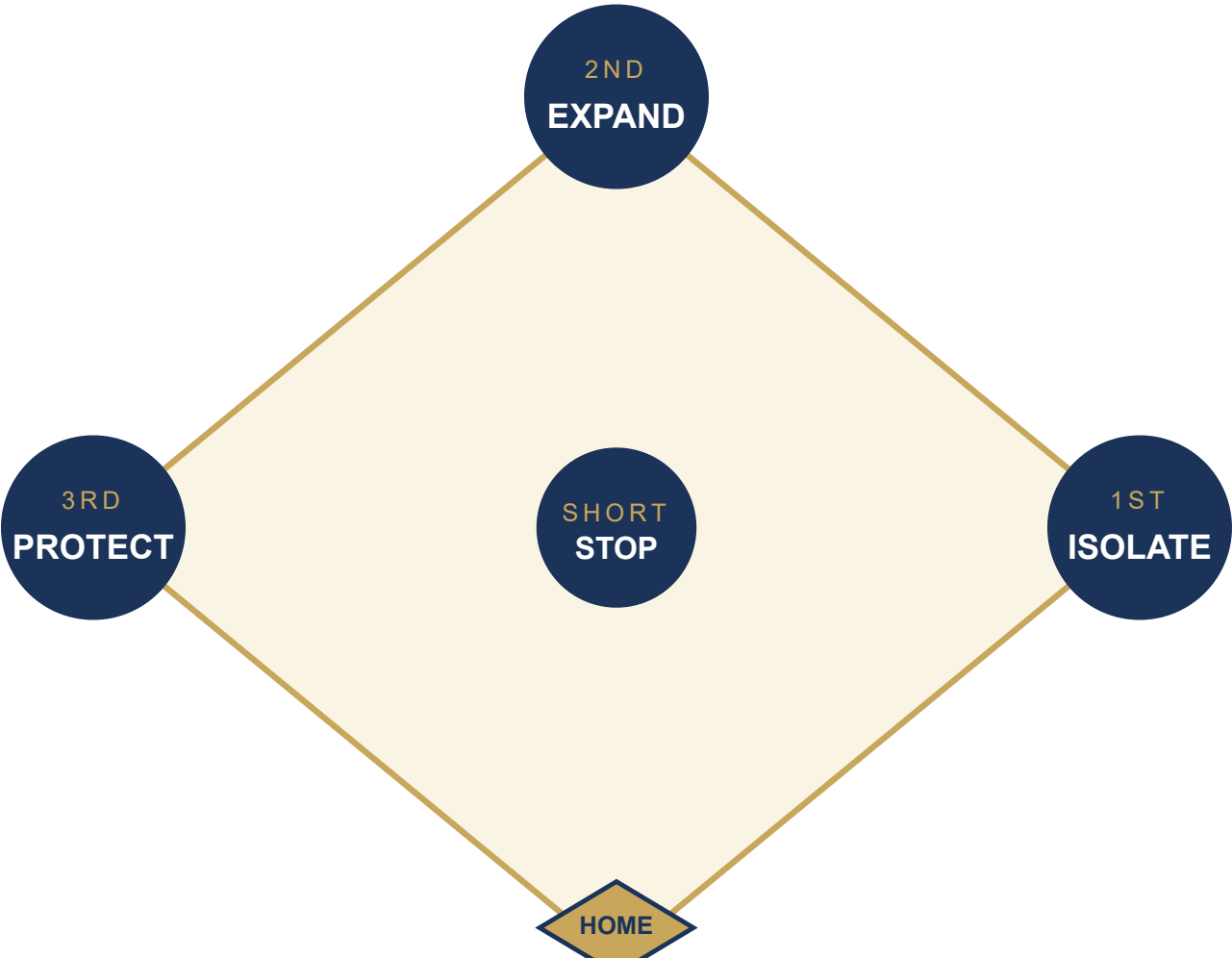


Figure 5.1 · The Diamond — touch every base, in order

Base	Topic	Authorize Before Advancing?
1st	Original concern (or safety if no concern)	YES
2nd	Additional inspection findings	YES
Short Stop	Re-open missed safety sale (fresh voice)	YES (or schedule)
3rd	Scheduled maintenance (now or within 10k)	YES (or schedule)
Home Plate	Final invoice review	n/a — closing

The Two Frameworks Inside Every Base

FRAMEWORK A

Good · Good · Bad

Two positives prime the brain into a receptive state. The third statement lands inside an open mind, not a defensive one.

FRAMEWORK B

P · R · S

Problem · Risk · Solution. Every finding, this exact order. Risk is the urgency engine — most advisors skip it.

STOP DO NOT mix bases on the same call.

Kitchen-sinking — dumping every finding into one call — feels efficient. It destroys trust. Each base is its own micro-conversation, with its own authorization. Hang up between bases. Re-call. Slower, much higher close rate.

LEVEL 5 — BASE-SELLING MASTERY

- ☐ Ran bases in correct order on every workflow.
- ☐ Used Good-Good-Bad framing on every base.
- ☐ Stated full PRS — never skipped Risk.
- ☐ Did NOT kitchen-sink. Hung up between bases.
- ☐ Tied total investment to coverage (warranty) without a pause.

CHAPTER 6

Present — Educate Into Certainty

An educated customer authorizes. A confused one defers.

OBJECTIVE EDUCATE	PACE RE-ENGAGE 60-90s	PRIMARY KPI PRESENT→AUTH %	FAIL MODE MONOLOGUE
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Re-Engagement Loops — Every 60-90 Seconds

The human attention span on a phone call is measured in tens of seconds. Long monologues lose the customer even when the content is correct. Every 60-90 seconds, insert a micro-question.

SCRIPT Re-engagement micro-questions

"Does that make sense so far?" / "Were you able to see that in the photo?" / "Any questions on what we've covered?" / "Is this still the best number?"

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER Why micro-questions multiply close rate.

Every "yes" the customer gives during the presentation is a small commitment that compounds toward the authorization "yes" at the end. By the time you ask for the work, they've already said yes a half-dozen times. The final yes is just one more small step.

The 10-Step ISO Safety Presentation (gold standard)

The canonical structure for any 1st-base safety call. Memorize the 10 beats. Plug in the technical content for any repair. Worked example: **Water Pump Leak**.

SCRIPT Base-1 ISO — Water Pump (template)

- 1. Warm Opening & Time Check.** "Hi [Customer], this is [Advisor] from [Shop]. Thanks for your patience — is now a good time to go over your vehicle?"
- 2. Advisor Co-Review (Credibility).** "I personally reviewed your vehicle with our certified technician so I could give you a clear picture of what's going on."
- 3. Media Confirmation.** "Were you able to view the photos/videos or the digital inspection report we sent over?"
- 4. Concern & Inspection.** "You brought your vehicle in for an oil change. We've completed the initial inspection and I wanted to review what we found."
- 5. Good News Positives.** "The good news is your digital inspection report clearly documents everything with photos and notes so you can see exactly what we're seeing, and we caught this early before it turned into a bigger issue."
- 6. More Good News (Discovery).** "More good news — during our inspection we found that your water pump is leaking, which is separate from your original visit and something we can take care of now before it leads to further damage."
- 7. Risk → Solution.** "If left as-is, a leaking water pump can lead to engine overheating, coolant loss, and eventually major engine damage. The proper repair is to remove and replace the water pump, and complete a full cooling system service so everything is clean, sealed, and operating at the correct temperature."
- 8. Total Investment.** "The total investment for today's work — including the cooling system service — is \$1,695.46, parts and labor included."
- 9. Coverage.** "This work is covered by our 3-year / 36,000-mile nationwide warranty — parts and labor."
- 10. Tee-Up & Callback.** "While your vehicle is here, we'll finish the full bumper-to-bumper digital inspection and I'll reach out if anything else needs attention. Is this still the best number to reach you?"

PRO TIP NO pause between Investment (8) and Coverage (9).

The #1 rookie mistake is pausing after stating the price — that pause is read as "wait for my reaction." Coverage must follow Investment in the same breath. Practice until muscle memory.

LEVEL 6 — PRESENTATION MASTERY

- ☐ Asked permission to speak before delivering findings.
- ☐ Confirmed DVI was viewed (or summarized with permission).
- ☐ Used Good-Good-Bad and full PRS on every finding.
- ☐ Investment immediately followed by Coverage — NO pause.
- ☐ Re-engaged at least every 90 seconds.
- ☐ Ended with a tee-up sentence for the next base.

CHAPTER 7

Overcome Objections — The 8 Boss Battles

Objections are not rejection. Objections are uncertainty wearing a costume.

The 5 Universal Rules

1. **Never argue.** Win the argument, lose the relationship.
2. **Acknowledge first, always.** "I completely understand" / "Fair enough."
3. **Find the real concern.** Clarifying questions before responding.
4. **Pivot to value or risk, never to discount.**
5. **Re-ask for the close.** Every exchange ends moving forward.

The Translation Matrix

What They Say	What They Mean	Your Move
"I'll sell the car"	Throwing money at a sinking ship	Reframe vs. used-car cost + unknown history
"Price is too high"	Not sure this is real value	Anti-lowest-price brag
"No money"	No money TODAY	Financing pivot
"Talk to spouse"	Need backup / delay	Three-way call bypass
"I'll wait"	Unsure of urgency	Safety vs. maintenance clarification
"You're always selling"	Don't fully trust you	Pro Obligation frame
"Need car today"	Logistics fear	Solve transport first
"Parts & labor breakdown?"	Comparison shopping	Refuse apples-to-apples

Boss 1 — "I'll Sell the Car"

SCRIPT Counter

"I completely understand. Big repairs can make you step back. Out of curiosity — are you planning to replace it with something newer or used?"
[If used:] "Most used vehicles today are still a major investment and you're inheriting someone else's maintenance history. With your vehicle, we know exactly what condition it's in because we just inspected it. The average used car is up to \$25,000 and insurance rates are outrageous. To get this vehicle back to safe and reliable we're talking about [total]. If you're looking to make a smart financial decision, my professional advice would be to repair, not buy a used car that may need the same in repairs or more."

Boss 2 — "Price Is Too High"

SCRIPT Counter — the anti-lowest-price brag

"I hear you. Is it more than you expected, or are you comparing it to another estimate? Fair enough. We're not positioned as the lowest-priced option in town — and that's intentional. We invest in experienced certified technicians. We back our work with a 3-year / 36,000-mile nationwide warranty. You're not just paying for parts — you're investing in doing it correctly the first time. Have you ever gone with the cheaper option before and ended up paying for it twice? That's exactly what we're helping you avoid. Let's get this handled properly. Is this still the best number?"

Boss 3 — "I Don't Have the Money Right Now"

SCRIPT Counter — the money reframe

"I completely understand. Auto repairs rarely show up at a convenient time. Something a lot of our customers love to take advantage of is our flexible payment options. If I can take care of the repair now and let you pay me back with no interest, can I get the parts ordered and move forward? [Send application link. Stay on the phone.]"

Boss 4 — "I Need to Talk to My Spouse"

SCRIPT Counter — the three-way bypass

"I completely understand. Decisions like this are best made together. To make sure both you and your spouse have all the correct information at the same time, the most efficient way to proceed is a brief three-way call. Is your spouse available to join us now, or should I reach out to them and call you back?"

Boss 5 — "I'm Going to Wait"

SCRIPT Counter — safety version

"I understand. I do want to be transparent — this one falls into a safety category. Right now [the brakes] are past normal wear and into potential damage. That affects stopping distance and control. Are you planning to drive it? Even short trips carry risk in this condition. My job is to protect you, not pressure you. If budget is the concern, we can look at payment options — but I don't recommend postponing something that affects safety."

Boss 6 — "You're Always Trying to Sell Me Something"

SCRIPT Counter — the Pro Obligation frame

"I appreciate you saying that. My goal isn't to sell you, it's to inspect your vehicle thoroughly and give you accurate information. Every car gets a full digital inspection — safety, wear, potential issues. You're never obligated to approve anything. But it's my professional obligation to make sure you know what we see. Would you like me to walk you through today's inspection results so you can decide what makes sense?"

Boss 7 — "I Need My Car Today"

SCRIPT Counter — solve transport first

"I understand. Let's solve the transportation side first. We have loaner vehicles, Uber rides, and pickup/drop-off options. Would one of those help? [Confirm.] Perfect. I'll get that arranged so we can repair your vehicle properly without rushing. Once it's complete I'll give you a call."

Boss 8 — "Can I Get a Parts and Labor Breakdown?"

SCRIPT Counter — refuse the commodity frame

"I can absolutely review the estimate with you. Just to clarify, we're not structured as a parts-and- labor shop. We're structured around protection and execution. You're paying for certified technicians, proper procedures, warranty coverage, and post-repair support. We also include 3-year / 36,000-mile warranty, roadside assistance, quality-control inspection, and digital documentation. That's why it doesn't break down into a commodity model. Does that help clarify where the value is?"

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER Why every Boss counter ends with another ask.

If an objection exchange ends in conversation, you've just had a conversation. Every counter must pivot back toward authorization. Otherwise the customer's brain interprets the silence as agreement to defer.

LEVEL 7 — BOSS RUSH MASTERY

- ☐ Defeated Boss 1 — Selling the Car
- ☐ Defeated Boss 2 — Price Too High
- ☐ Defeated Boss 3 — No Money Right Now
- ☐ Defeated Boss 4 — Talk to Spouse
- ☐ Defeated Boss 5 — I'm Going to Wait
- ☐ Defeated Boss 6 — You're Always Selling
- ☐ Defeated Boss 7 — I Need My Car Today
- ☐ Defeated Boss 8 — Parts and Labor Breakdown

All 8 in live calls within 30 days → Level 4 (PRO). Signed: _____ Date: _____

CHAPTER 8

Execute — The Close

Closing starts at hello. By Step 8 the close is already won or lost.

*Customers don't follow conviction. Customers follow certainty.
Your job is to be the most certain person in the conversation.*

The Three Families of Close

FAMILY 1

Assumptive

"I'll go ahead and get the parts ordered."
Customer must STOP motion to say no.

FAMILY 2

Choice (Binary)

"Option A or option B?" East-West applied
to any decision.

FAMILY 3

Logistical

"Which direction would you like the vehicle
facing?" Brain switches to logistics → price
silently accepted.

Assumptive Close Lines (use these by reflex)

- "I'll go ahead and move forward with that."
- "The parts will take a few hours to get here so long as I can hang up and place the order now."
- "Would you prefer option A or option B?"
- "Anything else you'd like to add before we move forward?"
- "We really need to fix this problem — do you need any more information from me?"

Home Plate — The Final Review

Home Plate is the start of the next sale. Done well, the customer becomes a repeat customer for life.

SCRIPT Home Plate Final Invoice Review

"[Mr./Mrs. Customer], thank you again for trusting us with your vehicle today. Here's what we completed: [services]. Everything is digitally documented in your invoice. Your total investment today is \$____. Which direction would you like your vehicle facing when we bring it up?

Before you head out, a few benefits included: 3-year / 36,000-mile nationwide warranty, 365-day roadside assistance, post-repair inspection, maintenance reminders, lifetime protection enrollment if applicable. We just want vehicle ownership to feel easy and predictable. We appreciate your business and we'll be here whenever you need us."

PSYCHOLOGY DECODER Why "which direction facing?" is the quietest power move in the book.

The brain processes "which direction" as a logistics problem. Logistics problems are answered on autopilot — the way the brain answers "cream and sugar?" By engaging with logistics, the customer's subconscious has just confirmed the transaction is complete. There is no longer anything to negotiate.

LEVEL 8 — CLOSE MASTERY

- ☐ Used at least one assumptive close line in every workflow.
- ☐ Investment stated as a single number; warranty followed immediately, no pause.
- ☐ Closed Home Plate with "which direction facing?"
- ☐ Re-enrolled customer in lifetime protection or maintenance plan where applicable.
- ☐ Asked for the next visit / review before customer left the lobby.

CHAPTER 9

L.A.S.T. — Turn Complaints Into Loyalty

An upset customer is a gift. Recover well and they become more loyal than baseline.

A customer who complains and is heard becomes more loyal than one who never had a problem at all.

The Service Recovery Paradox

The human brain has a negativity bias: bad experiences imprint 2-4× stronger than good ones. That sounds like terrible news for a shop with a complaint — but it's actually the unlock. When you reverse the experience with a great recovery, the *recovery itself* imprints with the same intensity. The customer no longer remembers the failure as a standalone event — they remember the recovery as the defining moment.

The Four Beats — In Order, Every Time

Beat	What You're Doing	Sounds Like	#1 Mistake
L — Listen	Letting cortisol drain	"Okay." "I understand." "Go ahead."	Interrupting to defend
A — Acknowledge	Mirroring emotion (not agreeing fault)	"I can understand why that would be frustrating."	"I understand BUT..."
S — Solve	Owning a specific time-bound next step	"Here's what I can do for you..."	Vague: "we'll look into it"
T — Thank	Reframing the complaint as a gift	"Thank you for giving us the chance to fix this."	Skipping because conversation feels done

STOP Forbidden words during recovery: "policy" · "but" · "however" · "although"

"Policy" tells the customer the rule matters more than they do. "But" deletes everything before it. Replace "policy" with "the way we handle this." Replace "but" with a period.

The Four Hot Counter Scripts

SCRIPT 1 "My car's been here two days and no one called me."

L: "Okay, walk me through it — when did you drop it off and what were you expecting?"

A: "I completely understand — not hearing back when you're waiting is one of the most frustrating things, and that's on us to do better."

S: "I'm pulling your RO now. I'll get you the current status, a real ETA, and I'll call you back personally within 30 minutes whether the news is good or not."

T: "Thank you for letting me know. We'd much rather hear this from you than read about it later."

SCRIPT 2 "The bill is way more than what you quoted."

L: "Tell me what number you were expecting and what you're seeing."

A: "That's a fair concern — if you were planning one number and the bill comes in higher, that breaks trust and I get why you're frustrated."

S: "Let me pull the estimate and invoice side by side. I'll walk you line by line, and if any of that wasn't properly authorized, I'll make it right today."

T: "I appreciate you raising this instead of just walking away unhappy."

SCRIPT 3 "I just paid for this last month and the same noise is back!"

L: "Tell me about the noise — when does it happen, exactly the same, did it ever fully go away?"

A: "That's exactly the kind of thing that should not be happening, and I understand why it feels like we let you down."

S: "We carry a 3-year / 36,000-mile warranty on parts and labor — this is covered. I'm getting you on the schedule today or tomorrow, no charge. When works?"

T: "Thank you for bringing it back instead of going somewhere else."

SCRIPT 4 "Your tech left grease on my seat."

L: "Can you show me?" [Walk to car. Do not minimize.]

A: "You're right — that's not what should happen. That's on us."

S: "We use seat covers on every job and that wasn't followed today. I'm getting this professionally detailed at our cost. I'll arrange a loaner or Uber. When works?"

T: "Thank you for telling me directly. This is how we get better."

LEVEL 9 — RECOVERY MASTERY (GATE TO CHAMPION)

☐ Listened for at least 30 seconds without interrupting, defending, or explaining.

☐ Acknowledged emotion before stating any facts.

☐ Did NOT use "but," "however," or "policy."

☐ Offered a specific, time-bound, owned next step.

☐ Did NOT discount or comp before solving the actual problem.

☐ Ended with a sincere Thank that reframed the complaint as a gift.

☐ Customer left committed to a next step.

All 7 across 3 live recoveries with documented retention → Level 5 (CHAMPION). Signed: _____ Date: _____

APPENDIX A

The Worked-Example Library

8 anatomized PRS scripts. The pattern is constant; the technical content varies.

Each example below follows the same 10-step ISO template you learned in Chapter 6 (water pump). The structure never changes. Memorize the pattern, vary the technical content.

1. Brakes — Front Pads & Rotors

PRS Risk → Solution

"If left as-is, the front pads are at 2 millimeters — that means metal-on-metal is the next stop, which destroys the rotors and can compromise stopping distance. The proper repair is to replace the front pads and rotors, perform a full brake system service including hardware and fluid bleed, and road-test under load to confirm."

2. Suspension — CV Axle Boot Leak

PRS Risk → Solution

"If left as-is, the torn boot lets the lubricating grease escape and lets dirt and water in. Inside of a few thousand miles that will destroy the CV joint, which can fail under acceleration and leave you stranded. The proper repair is to replace the CV axle assembly, inspect the inner joint and surrounding components, and verify alignment."

3. Cooling — Thermostat Stuck Open

PRS Risk → Solution

"The thermostat is stuck in the open position, which means the engine never reaches proper operating temperature. Beyond no heat in the cabin, this causes excess fuel consumption, increased emissions, and accelerated engine wear over time. The proper repair is to replace the thermostat and gasket and complete a partial coolant service to refresh the system."

4. Transmission — Fluid Service (3rd Base soft sell)

PRS Risk → Solution (soft)

"Old fluid loses its protective additives and starts depositing varnish on internal components. Left long enough, that leads to shifting issues and eventually transmission replacement — a multi-thousand-dollar repair. The service is a full fluid exchange with manufacturer-spec fluid and a filter replacement where serviceable."

5. Electrical — Battery + Alternator

PRS Risk → Solution

"The battery is testing at 60% of its rated capacity — it's past serviceable life. And the alternator is producing output below the manufacturer threshold at idle, which is why the battery isn't being properly recharged on short drives. Left as-is, this is a no-start event waiting for the right cold morning. The proper repair is to replace the battery with a manufacturer-spec unit and replace the alternator, then re-test the full charging system under load."

6. Tires — Replacement Set

PRS Risk → Solution

"All four tires are at 3/32-inch tread depth. The legal minimum is 2/32, but real-world stopping distance on wet pavement degrades significantly below 4/32. With the rainy season ahead, the risk is meaningfully longer stopping distance in exactly the conditions that need it most. The proper recommendation is a matched set of four new tires with a road-force balance, mount, and a 4-wheel alignment."

7. Alignment — Pull / Premature Wear

PRS Risk → Solution

"The left-front toe is out of specification — that's what's causing the pull, and it's scrubbing the inside edge of the tire. Left as-is, you'll need a full set of tires inside of 5,000 miles, plus the steering input it takes to keep the car straight increases driver fatigue and impacts emergency handling. The proper repair is a four-wheel alignment to manufacturer spec with a printed before-and-after report."

8. A/C — Low Refrigerant + Confirmed Leak

PRS Risk → Solution

"The refrigerant charge is critically low because the condenser has a confirmed leak. If we just recharge it without fixing the leak, you'll be back inside a few weeks with the same problem — and refrigerant venting to atmosphere is both environmentally and legally a concern. The proper repair is to replace the condenser, replace the receiver-drier, evacuate the system, and recharge to manufacturer specification with verified leak test."

PRO TIP Cross-library mastery = gate from Closer to Pro.

You're Library-certified when you can deliver any 3 randomly-selected examples from this appendix, back-to-back, from memory, with all 10 beats present and Risk explicit on every one. Coach signs off.

APPENDIX B

The Glossary

Every named technique in one place. Look it up, drill it, own it.

Booking & First Contact

East-West Scheduling	Two specific time options (one :15 after, one :45 before). Collapses scheduling infinity to binary.
The Relief Line	"You called the right place" — delivers limbic relief in first 10 seconds.
90-Second Friendship Window	First impression locks in this window. Highest-leverage 90 seconds of the sale.
Concern vs. Symptom	Customers describe symptoms; professionals diagnose concerns.
Custody	The vehicle in our bay. Every other objective is gated by this.

Trust & Credibility

Invisible Scorecard	Three traits every customer silently grades: Competence, Transparency, Trustworthiness.
Trust Triangle	Visual model of the Invisible Scorecard.
Three Channels of Rapport	Tone, Words, Body. Break one and the signal mixes.
Co-Review	"I personally reviewed with the tech" — scores Competence + Trustworthy simultaneously.
Media Confirmation	Locking in DVI evidence before delivering the finding.

Presentation Frameworks

Good-Good-Bad	Two positives before the finding/cost. Brain receives it in an open frame.
PRS	Problem · Risk · Solution. Mandatory 3-part structure for every finding. Risk is the urgency engine.
Base Selling (Diamond)	1st (Isolate) → 2nd (Expand) → Short Stop (Save) → 3rd (Protect) → Home Plate (Reinforce).
10-Step ISO Presentation	Canonical 10-beat structure for any 1st-base safety call.
Re-Engagement Loop (60-90s)	Micro-question every 60-90 sec to keep customer's mind in the call.
Investment-then-Coverage Rule	Warranty must follow price in the same breath. NO pause.

Objection Handling

Anti-Lowest-Price Brag	"We're not the cheapest, and that's intentional."
Money Reframe	"No money" = "no money TODAY" → financing pivot.
Three-Way Bypass	Counter to spouse objection — get them on the call live.
Pro Obligation Frame	Counter to "always selling" — fiduciary, not salesperson.
Short Stop Re-Open	Fresh voice to save a missed safety sale. New voice resets the social contract.

Closing

Assumptive Close	Skip the decision, move to logistics.
Choice (Binary) Close	"Option A or B?" — East-West applied to any decision.
Direction-Facing Close	"Which direction would you like the vehicle facing?" Brain switches to logistics.
Momentum Funnel	Trust accumulates downward; by Step 8 the close is gravity.
Home Plate	Final invoice review. Reinforces value, sets up next visit.

Recovery

L.A.S.T.	Listen · Acknowledge · Solve · Thank.
Service Recovery Paradox	Well-recovered customer ends up MORE loyal than baseline.
24-Hour Recovery Window	Recovery (<1hr) → Fading (1-24hr) → Review (>24hr).

Anti-Patterns (kill these on sight)

Quoting on phone	Loses the sale and the relationship.
Skipping the tour	Price objections triple.
Kitchen-Sinking	Dumping all findings in one call. Halves authorization.
Skipping Risk in PRS	"Let me think about it" becomes the standard reply.
Pausing after Investment	Triggers sticker shock.
Arguing with objections	Wins the argument, loses the customer.
Using "policy"	Tells the customer the rule matters more than they do.
"I understand, BUT..."	"But" deletes everything before it.

APPENDIX C

Your Mastery Tracker

The road from Rookie to Champion. Sign as you go.

Certification Ladder

Level	Requirement	Signed By	Date
L1 → L2 Advisor	6/6 Rapport mastery checks across 3 inbound calls	_____	_____
L2 → Tour Guide	5/5 Credibility checks across 3 live tours under 90 sec	_____	_____
Custody Cert	5/5 Custody checks; Inquiry-to-RO ≥ 70%	_____	_____
Inspection Cert	5/5 Inspection mastery; DVI w/ Media ≥ 95%	_____	_____
L2 → L3 Closer	5/5 Base Selling + 6/6 Presentation mastery across 2 workflows	_____	_____
L3 → L4 Pro	All 8 Boss Battles defeated in live calls within 30 days	_____	_____
L4 → L5 Champion	L.A.S.T. used on 3 real recoveries with documented retention + positive review	_____	_____

Personal KPI Tracker (weekly)

KPI	Target	Wk 1	Wk 2	Wk 3	Wk 4	Wk 5	Wk 6
Greet-to-Tour %	≥ 80%						
Inquiry-to-Appointment %	≥ 65%						
DVI w/ Media %	≥ 95%						
PRS Completeness %	100%						
1st-Objection Close %	≥ 60%						
Authorization Rate	≥ 75%						

The 5 Things I Will Do Every Shift

1. Stand and smile before I speak — every call, every door.
2. Use the customer's name at least 3 times in the first 2 minutes.
3. Never quote a price on the phone.
4. State Investment and Coverage in the same breath, no pause.
5. Fill out my self-audit worksheet at the end of every shift.

END OF THE ADVISOR BOOK

"Master every call. Win every bay. Build a book that follows you for life."

DO WHAT'S RIGHT · DO WHAT'S FAIR · DO YOUR BEST